Debate Notes

Argument Structure

Claim The Main Idea
Context Define your claim, origin and evolution
Truth Value/Causes Why is it good or bad? How does it exist in real world? (USE ANALOGIES AND EVIDENCES)
So What?/Consequences What Change/Impact does it bring about? Positive or Negative?
Impacts/Further Consequences What is the Final Impact(s) then? Analyze different kinds of impacts (DIFFERENT ACTORS IN A CATEGORY AFFECTED)
Comparative 1 Your World Scenario Vs Other Side World Scenario. Why is Your Scenario Better? Why is it better even in your worst case? Is it less harmful than the other sides? (ENGAGE WITH BEST CASE SCENARIO OF OTHER TEAM)
Comparative 2 Why is Your Impact more important in Weightage? Is it due to Scale? Magnitude? Proportion? Is it Long Term or Short Term? Moral?
Conclusion i.e the link to motion/How does this prove the motion?

Negative Argument Structure (Refutation)

What is the opposing teams underlying idea? Their Premise?
What are moral and practical reasons for why the idea is wrong? Is the idea relevant? If no, why not?
Has the team asserted or given process analysis/mechanisms? If given Why is that not true? (LOOK FOR CAUSATION!!!)
What is the team assuming? What is the reality? (CLARIFY!!!)
Is the evidence sufficient or correct? If not, why?
What is the Comparative of this situation in your world? Why is this a bad argument to win on? (Always try and take the arguments at their best and also use analogies to destroy them)

Analyzing Counterfactuals Models/Solutions/Actions

What is the framework? Who carries the Action? Are they the right authority?
What are the barriers to change?
Does it show positive changes? How sustaining are they? Efficiency
Does it worsen the situation or show bad changes? Counter Productivity
Short term Impacts
Long term Impacts
Does it Address/Engage with the Problem/Need Directly?
How does it Compare to other Sides Model?

General Clash/Issue/Questions Phrasings

1) **Characterization: Which Side Correctly Identifies the Origin, Evolution and Existence of X? OR How Does X Manifest In Reality?**

2) **Moral: Is X Morally/Principally Justified? OR Why X Trumps Y OR Why X OutWeighs Y?**
3) **Practical: Why X Maximises/Minimises utility OR Which Side Leads to Desirable Outcomes Or Why X causes more goods than harm, Vice Versa (When taking Different Practical Issues as Independent Ones in a Speech the phrasing would be (Why the Impact of X is better than Impact of Y on the particular actor or situation)**

Case Prep Method

Method (1 hour)

1) **10 Minutes Individual BrainStorm**
2) **10 Minutes Board Making**
3) **10 Minutes Discussion**
4) **10 Minutes Case Division**
5) **10 Minutes Pool of Rebuttals (Review Your Case)**
6) **10 Minutes Pool of Rebuttals (Review Other Teams Case)**

Outcome of Case

A) **Need/Problem/Opp Stance on Need/Problem (In Case of Policy/Action/Change Motion[Should, Would, Supports]**
B) **Real World Characterization of Important Key Terms [Especially in Narrative/Retrospective/Value Judgement/Assessment/Fact Motion [Regrets, Prefers, More Harm Than Good, Opposes, Etc]**
C) **Model Framework/Counterfactual**
D) **Moral Justification/Argument For Prop/Opp Side/Model With Most Significant Impact to Your Most Important Stakeholder, Comparative against Other Sides Moral Justification Against Your Model**
E) **Practical Justification(s) Comparative(s) of Distinct Benefits of Your Model and Distinct Harms of Other Sides Model to Other Primary and Or Other Stakeholders**

Individual Critical Thinking/Brainstorm

1) **Identify Key Terms of Motion and Note down points on each of them (see terms singularly and then combine them with other terms, number of key terms and Perspectives to view Motion would increase). Clearly and Reasonably Define Motion.**
2) **Identify Problem using Problem- Cause(s)- Harm(s)-Solution(s)-Impact(s). Use Evocative Language, Highlight Trends and Tipping Points and Avoid Problem-Solution Gap i.e Solution should directly affect the Problem and there should be no missing link(s)**
3) **For Identifying Moral/Practical Reasons and Process Analysis/Mechanism(s) i.e How does one thing happen or manifest in the real world. Use strategies such as Strengths- Weaknesses- Opportunities-Threats (SWOT) and Now-Action-Process-Then (NAT) Analysis For example Currently Smog has given rise to AQI levels(Now)- Government should use artificial rain(Action)- This will**

lead to (explain scientific Process by which rain reduces smog) and hence smog will reduce allowing lockdowns to be lifted (Then/Impact)

4) **Identify All Concerned Actor(s)/Stakeholder(s) to a motion and how they are impacted. Analyze at the Level of the Actor for example in a debate about Abortion, Women are a Primary Actor. However breaking it down into categories would lead to better impacting for example Married Home Makers, Single Mothers, Professional Women, Teen Mothers, etc. Show why empowering choice benefits each of these differently and is overall then better for women.**
5) **Create Model/CounterFactual by Analyzing (Already Explained Above in the same document)**
6) **Identify Framing/Criteria What is the underlying philosophical question that the debate asks us? What is the debate about? What does it require of your side to argue? How should the judges decide this debate? What should they value? (TELL THIS TO JUDGES IN BEGINNING OF EACH SPEECH, ADAPTING AND EVOLVING TO HOW DEBATE HAS EVOLVED)**
7) **Identify reasonable exception(s) to your case, scope of debate i.e in which context/relevance are you debating this motion for example TH welcomes Donald Trump as President Elect, Could be argued from multiple perspectives both domestic/international However, This House Would lockdown to combat smog is relevant to South Asian Countries only. Think about what clarifications you would have to make as a team.**
8) **Identify Evidences i.e Real World Examples, Case Studies, Facts, Statistics, Analogies, Logical Thought Experiments, etc. that prove your case.**

BoardMaking

1) **One Person Leads Case Prep Divide Board Into Three Columns. One Each for Setup(Characterization), Moral Arguments and Practical Arguments.**
2) **Divide Setup column into rows depending upon Motion for Key Terms, Definitions, Need, Model, Stakeholders, Framing, Criteria, Exceptions, Clarifications, Evidences, Endpoints of your team. Enlist them all. The Lead writes on board. All team members including them take turns in filling this up.**
3) **Enlist Moral Reasons in Moral Column, Note down any thing Important for Evidence and Explanation of the Reason that anyone says out in their turn. Do the same for Practical Reasons. Come up with as many independent differentiated reasons. Each can become a potential argument.**
4) **Prioritize Most Important to Least Important Idea/Phrase Your Claims/Lines of Argument**

Discussion

A) **Use Argument Structure to make a rough draft of arguments on board (FILL IT UP!!!). For each of the arguments everybody speaks in turn to add analysis and evidence including comparatives.**
B) **Make sure all arguments are concluded i.e they tie back to the motion or prove it for example, at the motion THBT COAS tenure extension causes the military more**

harm than good, Proposition claims why this policy leads to civil unrest, they analyze it with solid evidence why this is true and what harms it will lead to if civil unrest happens however motion talks about harms to military. They had to link why the military as a result of this incurs harm and therefore linking the claim back to motion.

C) Add Evidence Check For Evidence See if All Steps of Crafting An Argument have been followed.

Case Division

1) **Decide Which Arguments In Priority would the First Speaker Take and What will be the Second Speaker's Argument.**
2) **Prepare Clear Sheets (USE MARKERS OR MULTICOLOR PENS, CAPSLOCK AND WRITE POINTS NOT PARAGRAPHS!!!) well structured, especially Proposition One**
3) **Write your Lines/Labels of Argument on the board after completion of positive case sheets. 3 Arguments at least.**

Pool of Rebuttals

1) **Critique your case and make corrections, pre-empt refutations and bring clarity to the argument. (DON'T MAKE IT UNREASONABLE, ABSOLUTE, RADICAL OR TRY TO MAKE IT IRREFUTABLE) This means correct any things in Truth Value, Impact Analysis, Analogy and/or Evidences, Comparatives and Conclusions. Also think of responses to attacks that the other side would bring for your case**
2) **Pre-empt the other sides case and think about their principle and or practical arguments critically using the Negative Argument Structure (Also in this document) to develop refutations during case prep. Note them down and take them with you in the match room.**
3) **Make Direct/HardCase Questions to Ask during POIS (TAKE ONE AND ASK ONE IN A DEBATE WITHOUT EVEN QUESTIONING THE IMPORTANCE OF CROSS ENGAGEMENT!!!REALIZE THAT THIS IS A MUST)**

READING

1) **Preparatory phase**
   - **a) Read with a pen in your hand**
   - **b) Read with an open mind**
   - **c) Review background knowledge**
   - **d) Look at terms**
   - **e) Spot read**
2) **Reading phase**
   - **a) Notice organizational setup (Chapter themes, headings and subheadings)**
   - **b) Mark unfamiliar terms**
   - **c) Mark difficult passages**
   - **d) Make short notes**

3) **Second reading phase**
   a) Idea mapping
   b) Descriptive outlining (What the content says in bigger ideas, How it says in smaller ideas)
4) **Ending phase**
   a) Summarizing
   b) Internalizing